

MINUTES OF THE 44th CADSTL ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING
held at HELSBY COMMUNITY SPORTS CLUB ON 10th DECEMBER 2025

Apologies:

Pam Kloezeaman, Wrexham, Chester, Brymbo, Overton

Present:

John Simpson (Chairperson), Sue Long (Ladies Organiser), Joan Lythgoe (Treasurer), Alan Hewitt, (Mens Organiser) Kate Goldthorpe (Secretary)
Cheshire Oaks, Glan Aber, Helsby, Heswall, Hollies, Hooton, Port Sunlight, Tarvin, Thornton Hough, Upton, Wrexham,

Absent:

Hoole, Hoylake, Malpas, Mold, Neston, Pinewood, Tattenhall

The Chairman opened the meeting, thanking everyone for attending and hoped everyone had enjoyed an excellent season of tennis. He thanked Helsby Sports and Social club for use of the venue, Kate for organising and Joan for the refreshments.

Chairpersons Comments:

Sadly, Alan Lucas passed away this year. He was Chairperson of this league for 30 years, creating the legacy of a fun friendly league where the main objective is to play tennis – he made the league what it is. He received Honorary Colours from Cheshire LTA for his service to tennis recognising work for this league. He was very proud of this award. Several of the committee and members of Heswall LTC were present at the funeral. He was a lovely person and full of humour and will be much missed.

Thanks were given to Sue Long, who is stepping down as Ladies league organiser after approximately 25 years. She is going to assist our new league organiser as they take over the role. Many thanks were given from the committee and all the clubs.

Similarly, Alan Hewitt is also standing down after 10 years in role. Again he is happy to assist the next Mens and Vets organiser. Many thanks from the committee and all clubs. Thanks, were also given to Mike Beckett for handing the online system and fixing any errors.

There will be new web pages for the league next year. Web site <https://cadstl.com> Matthew Halliday (Wrexham LTC) will become the new webmaster. He has prepared new pages with information from Malcolm Willars and the committee.

Champions League, October

Mens: Hoylake, lost to eventual winners DLL Cheshire Oaks, in semi-final came 4th overall, Hoole (withdrew).

Ladies: Wrexham. lost to eventual winners DLL Cheshire Oaks, in semi-final came 4th overall, Hollie came 5th overall.

Minutes of the 2024 AGM held on 6th Nov. 2024:

Having been distributed prior to the meeting and no questions or comments, the minutes were approved.

Secretary's Comments:

Kate thanked the committee and former Secretary, Andy Cree, for all their support and guidance during her initial year in role.

As clubs will have noticed, some IT changes have been made to ease the workload and make administration and communication easier. Feedback and suggestions on further

improvements would be appreciated. We will continue to cater for those who do not wish to change from more traditional methods.

The setting up of fixtures was a major challenge with Andys historical knowledge being vital. In order to assist this year, it is very important that clubs advise of any court clashes or other restrictions when they submit their forms.

The Ladies mini league was a great success this year and we would like to incorporate these teams into the main league this year and also others that are on waiting lists for the mens and mixed leagues, if possible. This will involve some restructuring as allowed for in the rules, but if we could get more teams applying it would make life a lot easier. It should be noted that teams' locations must allow for travel from the furthest points in reasonable time. For those who have not yet submitted the initial request form, please do so as soon as possible so we can restructure the necessary leagues and include as many teams as possible. Thank you to all who have already responded.

Following the discussion last year, the committee have confirmed with all clubs they are LTA accredited and will therefore progress with registering the League as an LTA accredited league, hopefully before the start of the season.

League Organisers Reports:

Ladies – Sue Long

The mini league worked out very well. Only one fixture was outstanding at the end of the season, which did not affect the league positions.

The winners of each division were Wrexham, Helsby and Tarvin

Sue commented that there had been complaints regarding rules referring to rearranged matches. It was stressed that the league organisers do have the discretion to allow changes or not. To the best of her knowledge only one match was affected and this was due to County commitments, which she agreed to. It was commented that some clubs are helpful when it comes to rearrangements whereas others are a straight no. Sue responded that we can't force clubs to rearrange we can only appeal to their better nature. In view of the leagues ethos of a friendly league it was agreed that we can remind clubs to be considerate of oppositions situations when a request is made. It was noted that no club wants to rearrange unless essential. Sue introduced Manda Gillard who was standing as the new Ladies organiser.

Mixed – Pam Kloezeaman

Unfortunately Pam was unable to attend at the last minute and unable to give a report. The Chairperson confirmed that Pam had been in contact with all teams on a regular basis and the season went well.

Mens & Mens Vets – Alan Hewitt

Winner of the Mens league were Hoole A, Hollies B and Glan Aber B

This year saw the highest number of concessions in the league, in the last 10 years. 9 matches were conceded, which taking into consideration the good weather, was a huge number. One team was removed from the second division have not completed 75% of matches. Conceding a match should not be an option except under exceptional circumstances.

The Vets league was again won by Heswall, they did however lose 2 matches this season rather than one. The Vets league would benefit from more teams and a reminder that the age is now 55 and over.

Alan noted that the Organisers job now takes very little time, with little contact with captains other than occasionally entering results if they are submitted more than 2 weeks after the original playing date.

Treasurers Report

Joan thanked all those who had already paid for next season and requested that if paying by Bank Transfer they included the name of the club, not just the treasurers name.

Presenting the accounts, the slight loss of £55.00 was acknowledged as primarily being the increased cost of the shields and the flower for Alans wife after he passed away.

In view of the healthy financial position it was agreed that entry fees would remain at £8 per team.

Election of Officials for 2026

Manda Gillard has offered to be take on the role of Ladies organiser and was thanked by John for doing so. Sue was pleased this was someone who was regularly playing in the league.

To date no one has confirmed they would take over the Mens organiser role although there has been one possible contact from Glan Aber. Alan confirmed that there are now often weeks when no action is required. All to ask around for a volunteer as soon as possible.

Mike from Hollies asked if there could be a conflict of interest if playing in the league. The committee responded that with the committee supporting them there should be no conflict that cannot be handled and as long as everyone was treated equally then others should not complain.

With other officers remaining in place, the attendees agreed unanimously.

John added that he will be considering his own position as Chairperson next year.

Rules

The updated rules had been distributed prior to the meeting, with changes highlighted in red for ease. Whilst the proposed amendments have been suggested in order to clarify rules, they do still allow for rearrangements under exceptional circumstances, which can be requested and authorised by the league organiser. One rule that is essential is that all players must be registered on the results system, even if after playing when results are submitted.

Mike from Hollies noted that the AGM should be held by the end of November. The committee gave their apologies for the delay this year which was due to holidays.

Thornton Hough asked for clarification of the process if only 2 players could participate for a team and Upton asked if it was possible to send a mixed team with 3 ladies and 1 man, as this can be a challenge for a small club. It was clarified that 2 players could complete a fixture provided the opposition were informed. It was also clarified that an unbalanced combination of players in the mixed league is allowed (provided the opposition agrees), but one player would be ineligible and therefore would not get any points. However, the match would not be conceded.

Any Other Business

Clubs were advised prior to the meeting of the following request.

I wonder if the league would consider a simple change of language, from "ladies" to "women's". I understand the historic use of the term lady, maybe even some see it as polite. Personally, I find it quite jarring - it harks back to a time where "ladies" were expected to be demure, delicate, gentle. "Women" invokes independence and strength, much more befitting of the characteristics needed for sport and successful performance! And much more in line with current inclusive language.

It's a very simple request that most wouldn't even notice, but would make a huge difference to some, including me.

It was noted that with only half of clubs in attendance it was not appropriate to hold the vote

at the meeting, however a discussion was held. Comments included:

At the Cheshire LTA awards evening, the largest in the country, the term Women was not used at all.

The LTA use the term Ladies.

All international competitions and LTA major competitions use womens except for Wimbledon.

The formal organisation for female players is the WTA – womens tennis association

The request is a conscious change of language.

It was suggested that the request should be determined by the clubs, not the league committee. Kate is to contact all club contacts and, in consultation with the captains of ladies teams, to vote, with the option of yes, no, abstain or don't mind if the change is made.

John asked if anyone could suggest other events or activities the league can do for consideration. Pam Kloezeman has raised the potential for an end of season league tournament. This was generally considered a good idea and a nice way to close the season. Other suggestions should be sent to Kate.

Presentation of Trophies

The League Winners Trophies were presented to those attending as follows: -

Ladies

Division 1	Wrexham
Division 2	Helsby
Division 3	Tarvin
Mini	Neston

Mens

Division 1	Hoole A
Division 2	Hollies B
Division 3	Glan Aber

Mixed

Division 1	Hoole A
Division 2	Hoole B
Division 3	Heswall

Veterans Mens

Heswall

The meeting concluded at 20:32.